HEDGEYE

Summary Notes & Replay | Tuesday, April 21st, 2026

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TL;DR - POSITIONS MENTIONED

- **BULLISH:** Gold (AAAU), Platinum (PPLT), Bitcoin / IBIT, Silver, Pound, Canadian Dollar, Soybeans, Hong Kong, South Korea, China, Norway, Argentina, XLI, XTL, EXR
- **BEARISH:** Consumer Staples (XLP)

The summary and positions listed here reflect commentary from The Macro Show and may not represent the full scope of Keith McCullough's current portfolio positioning.

CLICK HERE to access today's slides.

MAIN SUMMARY

DOLLAR, GOLD, BITCOIN, AND INFLATION EXPRESSIONS

- Keith said the dollar breakdown is one of the key fulcrum points in the current quad shift and explicitly tied that to owning inverse-dollar assets. He said investors should be adding to gold if it is down and said he was buying more platinum on weakness. He also reiterated that they remain long Bitcoin. (2:27-3:24)
- The slide deck reinforces this directly: page 4 says the dollar turning bearish is central to the shift, notes **Long Bitcoin (IBIT)** as a new asset allocation on that shift, says **Long Gold (AAAU)** is being added to on down days, and says they are buying back **Platinum (PPLT)**.
- Keith said he wants to continue expressing the view that inflation is accelerating through explicit inflation allocations, not just by looking at oil. He referenced broader commodity inflation across cattle, cotton, tea, and the CRB Index. (2:43-3:48)

EARNINGS AND QUAD BACKDROP

- Keith said about 10% of the S&P 500 had reported and aggregate earnings growth had accelerated to roughly +32%, which he framed as a reflection of the prior Quad 1 setup feeding into Q1 earnings season. He said if investors are picking stocks in this environment, they

should focus on names with accelerating revenue and earnings doing "Quad 2 things." (3:48-5:26)

- The deck's "Top 3 Things" slide also highlights EPS growth of +32% year over year.

VIX, GAMMA, AND SHORT-COVERING FRAMEWORK

- Keith said the VIX remains below 19, which keeps it in the "investable bucket," and said gamma remains positive. He noted that the gamma flip happened on April 9 and that his macro short book had already peaked on April 2, with covers made into that window. (5:26-8:11)
- The deck supports that with page 6, which says the VIX moved back into the investable bucket, shows a VIX risk range of 16.34-21.78, and cites a Tier 1 Alpha gamma flip line of 6882, positive since April 9.
- Keith emphasized that when shorts go from bearish trade and trend toward bullish trade, he covers down to minimum size, and when bullish trend takes over, he gets out instead of fighting a squeeze. That process point was one of the most important parts of the show. (5:44-7:36)

U.S. EQUITIES AND SECTOR POSITIONING

- Keith said the market breakout has been significant and said the S&P 500 move has happened quickly off the drawdown lows. He also noted that down volume on a down day was bullish on the margin. (12:11-14:16)
- In sector positioning, he said **XLI, XTL, and EXR** are examples of bullish trade/bullish trend exposures he prefers to own. He contrasted those with weaker areas that are no longer acting as well. (14:18-15:29)
- The slide deck's sector tables on pages 22 and 23 support that broader rotation, showing stronger relative trends in Industrials, Materials, Tech, and Real Estate, while Staples and Health Care have lagged.

POSITION CHANGE: UTILITIES REDUCED

- **Keith said Utilities (XLU) broke immediate-term trade and would be reduced to minimum size.** He explained that when a bullish trade/bullish trend position first breaks trade, he now reduces it to minimum rather than automatically buying the dip. If it continues to weaken in a quad environment that does not favor it, it can be sold before trend breaks. (14:18-15:29; 23:14-26:07)

CURRENT SHORTS AND SHORT-SIDE MESSAGE

- Keith said **Consumer Staples (XLP)** is the only U.S. sector ETF he is currently short. He also said Health Care was becoming more interesting on the short side, but he explicitly said he did **not** currently have a position there. (15:13-15:48)
- Near the end of the show, Matt added that there are still good short opportunities in the short book, but they did not go into specific tickers on-air. (31:31-31:43)
- Keith also used Carvana and bitcoin-sensitive equities as examples of the kind of shorts he had covered as the signals improved. He was explicit that even if fundamentals still look bad, he does not stay short once the process flips against him. (28:34-30:58)

CREDIT, RATES, AND HIGH YIELD

- Keith said there was no major change in bond-yield risk ranges and that lower volatility there should be supportive for gold. He also said very clearly that investors should **not** be short high yield in the current setup, arguing that high yield improves going from Quad 3 to Quad 2. (15:48-16:27; 22:36-22:56)
- The volatility section of the slide deck supports that backdrop, with pages 31-35 showing lower bond and credit volatility conditions.

CURRENCIES AND COMMODITIES

- Keith said falling FX volatility is bearish for the dollar and specifically said the **pound** and **Canadian dollar** looked interesting on the long side. (16:09-16:48)
- He also said he had recently added **soybeans** and wants to own assets that benefit from accelerating inflation rather than staying concentrated in the same legacy growth exposures. (16:48-17:25)

SIGNAL CHANGES IN SINGLE NAMES

- **Apple and JPMorgan were flagged as moving from bearish trend to bullish trend.** Keith cited both as examples of names that had flipped positively on his process. (17:56-18:31)
- He said **Microsoft** remained bearish on trend and was still one of the few bearish names left on the broader sheet. (18:31-18:49)

ASIA AND INTERNATIONAL POSITIONING

- Keith said the book is now **net long Asia**, with long exposure bigger than short exposure. He said **Indonesia** would be **reduced to minimum** after two straight down days, while he remained **long Hong Kong**. (20:04-20:45)
- He said the **KOSPI in South Korea had made a new all-time high** and that they remain bullish there. He also said they would be bullish on **South Korea's quads** and **China's quads**, but

bearish on **Japan's quads**, and said he chose to buy **China and Hong Kong** instead of Japan. (20:45-21:16)

EUROPE, EM, AND REALLOCATION

- Keith said they were **"naked long Europe"** through **Norway**. He later said that in the morning he was **selling some Norway and buying Argentina**, describing that as part of a broader **reallocation to EM** that had already been underway. (22:36-22:56; 26:07-26:36)
- **Argentina** was the clearest same-day new buy discussed during the show, while the broader EM point was that they had already reallocated in multiple ways.

BOTTOM LINE

- The clearest explicit positioning messages from the show were: **remain long Bitcoin**, **add to gold on dips**, **buy/add back platinum**, **reduce Utilities (XLU) to minimum**, **remain short XLP**, **do not stay short high yield**, **favor stronger longs like XLI/XTL/EXR**, **stay bullish Hong Kong, South Korea, and China**, **trim Indonesia**, and **continue reallocating toward EM, including Argentina**.

SUMMARY HAS BEEN ENHANCED BY AI AND MAY CONTAIN ERRORS

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